(c) The world does not have enough resources to meet the impending food scarcity.
(d) Food security is increasingly a collective challenge.

Ans. (d) : In the passage, the author is telling that food security is an ever increasing collective challenge through the changing patterns of consumption, arable land and timely improvement and development of agriculture.

Passage-20

Many people in India feel that if we cut our defence expenditure on weapon-building, we can create a climate of peace with our neighbours, subsequently reducing the conflict or creating a no-war situation. People who proclaim such ideas are either the victims of war or the propagators of false argument.

25. With reference to the above passage, which of the following is the *most valid assumption*?
(a) Building of weapons systems by us has instigated our neighbours to wage wars against us.
(b) The greater spending on weapon-building by us would lessen the possibility of armed conflict with our neighbours.
(c) It is necessary to have state of the art weapons systems for national security.
(d) Many people in India believe that we are wasting our resources on weapon-building.

Ans. (b) : The passage rejects the arguments on defense expenditure, which means that there should be a belief and trust that a high expenditure on arms manufacturing can act as a major deterrent in averting a targeted war with our neighbours.

Passage-21

India accounts for nearly a fifth of the world's child deaths. In terms of numbers, it is the highest in the world—nearly 16 lakhs every year. Of these, more than half die in the first month of life. Officials believe that the reason for this is the absence of steps to propagate basic health practices relating to breast feeding and immunisation. Also the large reproductive population of 2.6 crore remains bereft of care during the critical phases of pregnancy and post-delivery. Added to this is the prevalence of child marriages, anaemia among young women and lack of focus on adolescent sanitation, all of which impact child death rates.

26. Which is the *critical inference* that can be made from the above passage?
(a) A lot of Indians are illiterate and hence do not recognize the value of basic health practices.
(b) India has a very huge population and the government alone cannot manage public health services.
(c) Universalization and integration of maternal health and child health services can effectively address the problem.
(d) The nutrition of women in child bearing age does not affect child mortality rate.

Ans. (c) : In the passage the author is telling that steps have not been taken to spread basic health practices like breast feeding and immunization to tackle the problem of child mortality.

Passage-22

Foods travel more than the people who eat them. Grocery stores and supermarkets are loaded with preserved and processed foods. This, however, often leads to environmental threats, such as pollution generated by long distance food transportation and wastage of food during processing and transportation, destruction of rain forests, reduced nutritional content, increased demand for preservation and packaging. Food insecurity also increases as the produce comes from regions that are not feeding their own population properly.

27. With reference to the above passage, which of the following statements is/are true?
1. Consuming regionally grown food and not depending on long travelled food is a part of eco-friendly behaviour.
2. Food processing industry puts a burden on our natural resources.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : Pollution caused by transportation of food items over long distances and wastages of food during processing and transportation, destruction of rain-forests, reduction in nutrient content etc. By looking at the statement, it is known that option (c) is correct answer.

Passage-23

I must say that, beyond occasionally exposing me to laughter, my constitutional shyness has been of no disadvantage whatever. In fact I can see that, on the contrary, it has been all to my advantage. My hesitancy in speech, which was once an annoyance, is now a pleasure. Its greatest benefit has been that it has taught me the economy of words. I have naturally formed the habit of restraining my thoughts. And I can now give myself the certificate that a thoughtless word hardly ever escapes my tongue or pen. I do not recollect ever having had to regret anything in my speech or writing. I have thus been spared many a mishap and waste of time. Experience has taught me that silence is part of the spiritual discipline of a votary of truth. Proneness to exaggerate, to suppress or modify the truth, wittingly or unwittingly, is a natural weakness of man, and silence is necessary in order to surmount it. A man of few words will rarely be thoughtless in his speech; he will measure every word. We find so many people impatient to talk. There is no chairman of a meeting who is not pestered with notes for permission to speak. And whenever the permission is given the speaker generally exceeds the time-limit, asks for more time, and keeps on talking without permission. All this talking can hardly be said to be of any benefit to the world. It is so much waste of time. My shyness has been in reality my shield and buckler. It has allowed me to grow. It has helped me in my discernment of truth.

28. The author says that a thoughtless word hardly ever escapes his tongue or pen. Which one of the following is not a valid reason for this?
(a) He has no intention to waste his time.
(b) He believes in the economy of words.
(c) He believes in restraining his thoughts.
(d) He has hesitancy in his speech.

Ans. (a) : The writer says that hardly a word comes out of his tongue or pen without thinking. Because he pays a lot of attention to his word selection or balance in speech or control of thoughts. Hence, option (b), (c) & (d) are valid reasons and option (a) is invalid.

29. The most appropriate reason for the author to be spared many a mishap is that
(a) he hardly utters or writes a thoughtless word.
(b) he is a man of immense patience.
(c) he believes that he is a spiritual person.
(d) he is a votary of truth.

Ans. (a) : The author categorically states in the passage that I can now testify to myself that hardly any words come out of my tongue or pen without thought. In this way I am saved from many dangers and also saved a lot of time. Hence, on this basis option (a) is the correct answer.

30. For the author, silence is necessary in order to surmount
(a) constitutional shyness.
(b) hesitancy in speech.
(c) suppression of thoughts.
(d) tendency to overstate.

Ans. (d) : In the passage, the author says that the natural weakness of man is that he often exaggerates, knowingly or unknowingly. Silence is necessary to overcome this. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

LOGICAL & ANALYTICAL ABILITY

31. A selection is to be made for one post of Principal and two posts of Vice-Principal. Amongst the six candidates called for the interview, only two are eligible for the post of Principal while they all are eligible for the post of Vice-Principal. The number of possible combinations of selectees is
(a) 4 (b) 12
(c) 18 (d) None of the above

Ans. (d) : First of all, out of two eligible characters, the principal can be selected in two ways. Thereafter the Vice-Principal can be selected from the remaining 5 candidates in the ${}^5C_2$ mode. Hence, total number of variants,
$= 2 \times {}^5C_2$
$= 2 \times 10 = 20$
Hence option (d) is the correct answer.

32. A student has to opt for 2 subjects out of 5 subjects for a course, namely, Commerce, Economics, Statistics, Mathematics I and Mathematics II. Mathematics II can be offered only if Mathematics I is also opted. The number of different combinations of two subjects which can be opted is
(a) 5 (b) 6
(c) 7 (d) 8

Ans. (c) :
In two types of situations,
1. Taking mathematics II.
2. Not taking mathematics II.
(i) One can take mathematics I and mathematics II only in one way.
(ii) 2 out of the remaining 3 can be selected in the way ${}^3C_2 = 6$.
Hence, the total number of ways = 1 + 6 = 7
Hence option (c) will be the correct answer.

33. A person ordered 5 pairs of black socks and some pairs of brown socks. The price of a black pair was thrice that of a brown pair. While preparing the bill, the bill clerk interchanged the number of black and brown pairs by mistake which increased the bill by 100%. What was the number of pairs of brown socks in the original order?
(a) 10 (b) 15
(c) 20 (d) 25

Ans. (d) :
Let the number of pairs of brown socks be X.
Let the cost of a pair of brown socks be Rs. 1.
Hence, the value of the pair of black socks = Rs. 3
Initial Bill should be Rs. $(5 \times 3 + x \times 1)$
Bill after exchange = $(x \times 3 + 5 \times 1)$
Now, bill has increased by 100%
Hence, it is double of the initial bill.
Therefore,
$3x + 5 = 2(15 + x)$
$x = 30 - 5$
$x = 25$
So, option (d) is the correct answer.

34. The number of persons who read magazine X only is thrice the number of persons who read magazine Y. The number of persons who read magazine Y only is thrice the number of persons who read magazine X. Then, which of the following conclusions can be drawn?
1. The number of persons who read both the magazines is twice the number of persons who read only magazine X.
2. The total number of persons who read either one magazine or both the magazines is twice the number of persons who read both the magazines.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (*) : This question was dropped.